CYBERSECURITY MEMO

PREPARED FOR:	Keystone State Healthcare
TO:	CISO, Senior Leadership Team (CEO, CFO, COO, CIO, CSO)
FROM:	Brendan Reed | Cyber Risk Director | brendan@keystonecare.org
DATE:	10 February 2026
RE:	**Sunshine Merger Cybersecurity Action Plan**

Executive Summary: With Keystone State Healthcare's recent acquisition of Sunshine Clinics, our Northeast based healthcare network is growing rapidly. The 5 hospitals bearing the Keystone name will be joined by 45 Sunshine Clinic outpatient facilities by the end of 2026. During this transition period, patients, practitioners, electronic health records (EHR), and data may be highly exposed. The Keystone cybersecurity team is proposing a cyber strategy adoption to limit risk exposure and protect assets during.

To protect our patient data, maintain HIPAA compliance, and ensure operations remain normal, the cybersecurity team recommends implementing two complementary cybersecurity frameworks:

- **STRIDE**: Proactive threat modeling to help developers & engineers **design out threats early**.
- **ATT&CK**: Proactive & Reactive threat detection. Think like attackers to **maintain resiliency.**

These frameworks operating in tandem will provide comprehensive protection throughout the iterative process of the Sunshine merger. Below is a brief summary outlining exactly what these frameworks will look once fully implemented and what that means moving forward throughout the acquisition.

	STRIDE	MITRE ATT&CK
Goal during acquisition	• Design merged systems securely and avoid preventable failures which could lead to breach.	• Detect and stop real attackers quickly. • Isolate and mitigate cyber damage.
Assets Protected	• Electronic Health Records (EHR) systems and underlying databases (confidentiality, integrity) • Integration points between both health systems. • Third-party vendor integrations (supply chain)	• Endpoints (workstations/medical devices) • Cloud workloads handling PHI • Operational systems (Labs, Imaging)
Business Value	• Prevents vulnerabilities before deployment. • Reduces likelihood of system compromise.	• Reduces detection time. • Minimizes damage. Accelerates incident response.
How to begin implementing	• Identify key stakeholders for critical systems. • Begin enumerating processes for threat models. • Collect log sources, telemetry, SIEM metrics.	• Identify potential threats and attack vectors within our healthcare orgs. • Map threats & high-risk vulnerabilities using Mappings Explorer. • Deploy S.O.C. and monitoring tools.

The Keystone Healthcare Cybersecurity team is requesting the support of the C-Suite as we work with Sunshine Clinics to securely merge our organizations using the recommended risk frameworks.

In addition to executive support, the cybersecurity team is **requesting appropriate early-stage funding** to complete this process efficiently. Appropriate spending at these early stages of systems engineering will ensure patient security and regulatory requirements are adhered to, potentially avoiding costly penalties in the future.

Finally, my team is requesting executive **approval for a public communications initiative** that reinforces our commitment to protecting patient's digital data.

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